Lance Grimsley

Stow, OH | Lance.Grimsley@protonmail.com | https://www.linkedin.com/in/lance-grimsley-a80323408/ | https://github.com/legosandjoysticks | https://legosandjoysticks.github.io/

PRODUCT ENGINEER

Product engineer who designed, built, launched and operates Deal Meal Planner, a subscription grocery-planning product on the App Store and the web. Twenty years as a teacher designing systems for real people, now applied to software. Builds with AI coding agents while owning architecture, review and production.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, JavaScript, Swift, SQL, HTML, CSS

Product stack: React, Vite, SwiftUI, FastAPI, SQLite, REST APIs

AI: OpenAI API, LLM classification with rule-based guardrails, prompt design, AI coding agents (Claude, Codex)

Payments & platform: Stripe, StoreKit 2 / App Store subscriptions, Clerk auth, Siri App Intents

Quality & ops: pytest, Playwright, Linux, PM2, Cloudflare, monitoring and alerting, backups, Git

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Product Engineer, Deal Meal Planner

Self-employed | Stow, OH | April 2026 - Present

- Designed, built and launched (October 2026) a subscription product that turns weekly grocery ads from six Northeast Ohio chains into dinners and store-by-store shopping lists: native iPhone app, React web app, and a weekly email and web food magazine.
- Built the data pipeline that ingests 3,200+ deals a week, normalizes multi-buy, BOGO and "mix or match" pricing, and labels 7,000+ products with an LLM plus rule-based guardrails; every confirmed labeling error becomes a permanent regression test.
- Built shopper-language search across all stores, with a synonym layer checked against real ads ("toilet paper" finds "bath tissue", "coke" finds Coca-Cola) and guards against false matches.
- Shipped AI features: deal-first recipes built from up to six of the week's sales, a chef chat that tweaks a recipe or re-shops it at another store, meal plans from a fridge photo, and Siri shortcuts.
- Implemented Founder and Plus tiers across Stripe and App Store subscriptions with one entitlement model, free-tier quotas, server-side receipt signature verification, and anti-scraping limits.
- Ran the launch end to end: App Store releases with monthly and yearly plans and two free dinners for new accounts, a filmed in-store demo video, SEO pages for every store's weekly ad, Pinterest auto-publishing, referral tagging, and out-of-area ZIP tracking to choose the next market.
- Run production on a self-hosted Linux server: 1,600+ automated tests, health checks with text alerts, a dead-man switch on monitoring, backup-before-change runbooks, and written incident notes.
- Led AI coding agents as the engineering team: set architecture and priorities, reviewed every change, wrote the guardrails and tests, and owned what reached production.

Media / Language Arts Teacher

Barberton City Schools | Barberton, OH | August 2007 - Present

- Twenty years designing curriculum, routines and feedback systems for classrooms of teenagers with different needs, attention and motivation.
- Explain complex ideas clearly to students, families and colleagues, in writing and in person.
- Manage competing priorities, deadlines and high-volume feedback in a demanding, people-first environment.

EDUCATION

Master's in Principalship / Educational Leadership | University of Akron | 2012

Master's in Language Arts Education with Licensure | University of Akron | 2007

Bachelor of Business Administration, Marketing | Kent State University at Stark | 2000

LINKS

- Product: https://dealmealplanner.com | iPhone: Deal Meal Planner on the App Store
- Case study: https://github.com/legosandjoysticks/deal-meal-planner-case-study